



BOARD OF INTERMEDIATE & SECONDARY EDUCATION, LARKANO

Established to serve affiliated schools and colleges across the Larkano region

Higher Secondary School Certificate
Examination Syllabus

PAKISTAN STUDIES

Grade XII

This syllabus will be examined in both Annual and Re-sit Examination sessions beginning with the Annual Examinations 2023.

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Preface

The Board of Intermediate & Secondary Education, Larkano (BISE Larkano) is a public examination body responsible for the conduct of Secondary School Certificate (SSC) and Higher Secondary School Certificate (HSSC) examinations for its affiliated schools and colleges. The Board is committed to developing examination syllabi that promote conceptual understanding and informed civic awareness, and that remain aligned with the national curriculum.

This document sets out the syllabus for Pakistan Studies at the HSSC level (Grade XII). It has been developed in recognition of the subject's role in building an informed understanding of the country's history, geography, constitutional structure, economy and place in the world — knowledge expected of every graduate of an affiliated institution regardless of their chosen field of further study.

The syllabus was developed following consultation with subject specialists, teachers of affiliated institutions, and reviewers with expertise in the teaching of Pakistan Studies, and reflects a deliberate effort to move examination preparation away from rote memorisation of dates and toward informed explanation and evaluation.

We are confident that this syllabus will support teachers and students of affiliated institutions in building a well-rounded understanding of Pakistan, and we wish every success to those who study and teach it.

Controller of Examinations

Board of Intermediate & Secondary Education, Larkano

Understanding of BISE Larkano Syllabi

1. The BISE Larkano syllabi guide students, teachers, parents and other stakeholders regarding the topics that will be taught and examined in each grade. In each syllabus document, the content progresses from simple to complex, facilitating gradual, conceptual learning.
2. The topics of each syllabus are divided into sub-topics and Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs). The sub-topics and SLOs define the depth and breadth at which each topic will be taught, learnt and examined.
3. Each SLO begins with an achievable, assessable command word such as ‘describe’, ‘explain’, ‘outline’ or ‘evaluate’. Examination questions are framed using the same command words, or their equivalents, to elicit evidence of these competencies in students’ responses.
4. The SLOs are classified under three cognitive levels: Knowledge (K), Understanding (U), and Application and other higher-order skills (A), to support effective planning by teachers and the balanced construction of examination papers.
5. By focusing on the achievement of SLOs rather than on the reproduction of memorised dates and names, this syllabus aims to encourage students to explain causes and consequences, to evaluate policy and events, and to communicate their thinking clearly — skills that extend well beyond a single assignment or examination.
6. While the syllabus recommends locally available textbooks and resources for achieving these outcomes, teachers and students are encouraged to draw on multiple teaching and learning resources, including official statistics and government publications, and to acknowledge any resource that materially shapes an answer submitted for assessment.

Subject Rationale of Pakistan Studies

What will you learn in Pakistan Studies?

Pakistan Studies is the study of the country's ideological foundations, its history, its land and people, its system of government, its economy and its place among nations. This syllabus teaches students to explain how Pakistan came to be, how it is governed, and the opportunities and challenges it faces, and to support their explanations with evidence rather than with memorised statements.

Many students who can recall a date or an event have not yet learned to explain its significance — to connect a constitutional provision to how government actually functions, to weigh the arguments for and against a policy, or to relate Pakistan's geography to its economic life. This syllabus addresses that gap directly. Students will study the ideological and historical background of Pakistan, its land and natural resources, its constitutional and political system, its economy, and its society, culture and international relations.

Throughout, the syllabus emphasises informed explanation and evaluation — in the examination room and as a citizen — rather than the recall of isolated facts.

Why does every student study this subject?

Pakistan Studies is a compulsory subject for every HSSC candidate at affiliated institutions, regardless of their chosen group of study. It provides the shared civic and historical knowledge expected of an educated citizen, and complements each student's specialised subjects with an understanding of the country in which they will live and work.

How to approach the syllabus?

The concept map on the following page gives an overview of the entire syllabus. The topics and Student Learning Outcomes guide what has to be achieved, and the Scheme of Assessment explains how each topic will be weighted and examined.

Concept Map

The concept map below organises the syllabus into four connected strands, all resting on a foundation of Informed Civic Reasoning — the ability to explain and evaluate, rather than simply recall, the forces that have shaped Pakistan.

Ideology and History

- The Ideological Basis of Pakistan
- The Freedom Movement
- Constitutional Landmarks to 1947

Land and People

- Physical Geography of Pakistan
- Natural Resources and Environment
- Population and Settlement

Government and Economy

- The 1973 Constitution
- Institutions of the State
- Structure of the Economy
- Economic Challenges and Policy

Society and the World

- Culture and Society Across the Provinces
- The Role of Key National Institutions
- Principles of Foreign Policy
- Pakistan's Regional Relationships

Informed Civic Reasoning underpins all four strands: every explanation of an event, every evaluation of a policy, and every discussion of Pakistan's place in the world in this syllabus is ultimately a tool for reasoning carefully from evidence to a defensible conclusion.

Student Learning Outcomes of Pakistan Studies

This syllabus is studied and examined in Grade XII.

1. Ideology and Historical Perspective of Pakistan

Topics and Sub-topics	Student Learning Outcomes	K	U	A
1.1 Ideological Basis of Pakistan	describe the ideological basis on which the demand for a separate Muslim homeland in South Asia was founded;	✓		
	explain the contribution of a named leader to the development of the Pakistan Movement;		✓	
1.2 The Freedom Movement	outline the major constitutional and political landmarks leading to the independence of Pakistan in 1947;	✓		
	evaluate the significance of a named event or pact in the freedom movement;			✓

2. Land, Environment and People of Pakistan

Topics and Sub-topics	Student Learning Outcomes	K	U	A
2.1 Physical Geography	describe the major physical regions of Pakistan;	✓		
	explain the influence of climate and terrain on the distribution of population and economic activity;		✓	
2.2 Natural Resources and Environment	describe the major natural resources of Pakistan;	✓		
	evaluate a strategy for addressing an environmental challenge facing Pakistan, e.g. water scarcity or deforestation;			✓

3. Government and Political System of Pakistan

Topics and Sub-topics	Student Learning Outcomes	K	U	A
3.1 Constitutional Development	outline the main features of the 1973 Constitution of Pakistan;	✓		
	distinguish between the roles and responsibilities of the federal and provincial governments;		✓	
3.2 Institutions of the State	describe the structure and function of the legislature, executive and judiciary of Pakistan;	✓		
	explain the process by which a bill becomes law in Pakistan;		✓	
	evaluate the effectiveness of a named state institution in fulfilling its constitutional role;			✓

4. Economy of Pakistan

Topics and Sub-topics	Student Learning Outcomes	K	U	A
4.1 Structure of the Economy	describe the major sectors of Pakistan's economy, i.e. agriculture, industry and services;	✓		
	explain the contribution of a named sector to national economic development;		✓	
4.2 Economic Challenges and Policy	evaluate a policy measure intended to address a named economic challenge facing Pakistan, e.g. inflation or unemployment;			✓

5. Society, Culture and Pakistan's Role in International Affairs

Topics and Sub-topics	Student Learning Outcomes	K	U	A
5.1 Society and Culture	describe the cultural diversity of Pakistan's provinces and regions;	✓		
	explain the role of a named institution in promoting social welfare or education in Pakistan;		✓	
5.2 Foreign Policy	describe the basic principles guiding Pakistan's foreign policy;	✓		
	explain the significance of Pakistan's relationship with a named neighbouring or allied country;		✓	

Scheme of Assessment

Pakistan Studies is examined through a single Theory paper carrying 50 marks, matching the maximum marks shown against 'Pakistan Studies' on the BISE Larkano Marks Certificate. There is no separate Practical component for this subject.

Table 1: Number of Student Learning Outcomes by Cognitive Level

Topic No.	Topic	No. of Sub-topics	K	U	A	Total
1	Ideology and Historical Perspective of Pakistan	2	2	1	1	4
2	Land, Environment and People of Pakistan	2	2	1	1	4
3	Government and Political System of Pakistan	2	2	2	1	5
4	Economy of Pakistan	2	1	1	1	3
5	Society, Culture and Pakistan's Role in International Affairs	2	2	2	0	4
	Total	10	9	7	4	20
	Percentage		45%	35%	20%	100%

Table 2: Theory Exam Specification — Pakistan Studies — 50 Marks

Topic No.	Topic	MCQs (Marks)	CRQs (Marks)	Total Marks
1	Ideology and Historical Perspective of Pakistan	4	6 (1 CRQ)	10
2	Land, Environment and People of Pakistan	4	6 (1 CRQ)	10
3	Government and Political System of Pakistan	4	8 (1 CRQ)	12
4	Economy of Pakistan	3	6 (1 CRQ)	9
5	Society, Culture and Pakistan's Role in International Affairs	3	6 (1 CRQ)	9
	Total	18	32	50

Table 2A: Overall Marks Distribution

Component	Certificate Entry	Marks
Theory Examination	Pakistan Studies	50
Total		50

- A Multiple Choice Question (MCQ) requires candidates to choose one best/correct answer from four options. Each MCQ carries ONE mark.
- A Constructed Response Question (CRQ) requires students to respond with a structured explanation, a short essay, or an evaluation of an event, policy or institution, as appropriate to the SLO being assessed.
- The Theory examination carries 50 marks, is of 2 hours' duration, and consists of Paper I (MCQs) and Paper II (CRQs).

- Unlike the science subjects examined by the Board, Pakistan Studies has no Practical component: the 50 marks recorded against 'Pakistan Studies' on the Marks Certificate represent the Theory examination in full.
- Table 1 indicates the number and nature of SLOs in each topic and is provided as a guide to the construction of examination papers; it does not translate directly into marks. Emphasis has deliberately been placed on Understanding and Application, to discourage rote memorisation of dates and names.
- Where a CRQ asks students to evaluate a policy, an institution or an event, full credit requires a reasoned judgement supported by evidence, not merely a description.

Academic Integrity

All work submitted for assessment in Pakistan Studies — whether a short answer, an essay, or an evaluation — must represent the individual, honest effort of the student submitting it. Affiliated institutions are expected to uphold the BISE Larkano Academic Integrity Policy in full, and to make students aware of the following subject-specific guidance.

Collaboration and Use of Sources

Students are encouraged to discuss historical events, constitutional provisions and current economic or social issues with their peers, and to consult the prescribed textbook and other reputable resources, including official government publications, to build their understanding. However, copying an answer or an essay from any source — including another student, a book, or an online resource — and submitting it as one's own, with or without superficial changes, is a serious violation of academic integrity.

Accuracy and Fair Representation

Students are expected to represent historical events, figures, statistics and current affairs accurately and fairly, and to distinguish clearly between an established fact and their own opinion or evaluation. Where a question asks for an evaluation or a judgement, students are encouraged to consider more than one perspective before reaching a reasoned conclusion.

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